

employed purely as a batter and has bowled just a solitary over in 11 matches. In six of those games, Dube has been part of Impact Player swaps, either coming in as a batter after Super Kings have fielded or being subbed out at the end of the batting innings.

Though Dube has never consistently bowled a healthy diet of overs in the IPL, he was coming into the tournament on the back of having bowled a significant 67 overs in five Ranji Trophy games for Mumbai. He, however, bowled just four overs in eight matches during the last Syed Mushtaq Ali domestic T20 competition.

Krunal Pandya, Shardul Thakur, Rahul Tewatia, and Ramandeep Singh have also been unable to display their wares in both departments since the advent of the Impact Player rule. It is quite telling that the only Indian players to have scored more than 100 runs and picked five or more wickets this season are Hardik Pandya, Ravindra Jadeja, and Axar Patel.

Last year, only Axar, Jadeja, Krunal, and Shardul made the cut among Indians. In 2022, before the Impact Player rule, seven Indians (Hardik, Ravichandran Ashwin, Krunal, Axar, Shardul, Jadeja, and Washington) had achieved the dual feat.

While Shardul has played just six out of CSK's first 11 games, largely owing to the defending champion's preference for a specialist bowler with a similar skillset, Krunal's batting position at Lucknow Super Giants has seen him face just 59 balls across nine innings. In 2022, he batted at No. 4 and 5 in eight out of 13 innings, while this year he has been slotted only at No. 7 and 8.

Meanwhile, Tewatia, who burst onto the scene as a bowling all-rounder in 2014, has been typecast as a death-overs specialist with the bat and is yet to bowl a ball in Gujarat Titans' first 11 games.

This is not to say that all-rounders have become completely extinct in the context of the Impact Player rule. After all, the list of players who have scored more than 100 runs and picked five or more wickets this

season includes the likes of Sunil Narine, Andre Russell, Sam Curran, Rashid Khan, and Cameron Green.

However, these are well-established names that add value with bat and ball to an almost equal degree. But what warrants urgent attention is the development of India's next supply line of all-rounders, which the Impact Player innovation seems to impede. The fact that the last two editions of India's domestic T20 tournament, the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy, have also opted for the provision hasn't helped in identifying the next generation of all-rounders.

Hardik is still India's only seam-bowling all-rounder of international repute, and, with his performance under a cloud, he too has made use of the cushion of an extra bowler provided by the Impact Player rule. In 11 matches, he has not bowled at all twice and has completed his quota of four overs in just four games.

With India's team balance largely dependent on Hardik's ability to deliver his full quota of overs at the T20 World Cup, where the Impact Player provision doesn't apply, it

doesn't bode well for the national team.

Though it's still a long shot, Sunrisers Hyderabad's Nitish Kumar Reddy perhaps comes closest to replicating Hardik's skills among Indians. But he too has largely been employed as a specialist batter, having bowled just 7.1 overs in seven matches.

India has long been plagued by the inability of its top-order batters to roll their arm over, and that shortcoming has spilt over into the upcoming global showpiece. The onset of the Impact Player rule has also diminished the role of part-timers, such as Deepak Hooda and Riyan Parag, and has left in its wake a legion of unidimensional strongmen, emboldened by the mirage of a Promised Land (read Impact Player rule), that doesn't exist on the international arena.

Undoubtedly, the provision has helped unlock the potential of the likes of Ashutosh Sharma and Abishek Porel on the big stage, but is that a trade-off Indian cricket is willing to make at the cost of the development of future Hardiks and Jadejas?

Player	Mat	Runs	Bat Av	HS	Wkts	Bowl Av	BBI
 Hardik Pandya	61	1278	32.76	87	58 2	4.05	4/16
 Ravindra Jadeja	50	1139	33.50	112	89	25.62	7/42
 Axar Patel	64	1040	28.10	84	67	29.44	4/77

Indian players with 500+ runs and 5+ wickets in all internationals since May 7, 2022 (last two years)

Player	Mat	Runs	Bat Av	HS	Wkts	Bowl Av	BBI
 Sunil Narine	11	461	41.90	109	14	20.78	2/22
 Ravindra Jadeja	11	202	50.50	57*	8	34.50	3/18
 Hardik Pandya	11	198	19.80	46	8	37.12	2/26
 Andre Russell	11	198	33.00	64*	13	17.46	3/25
 Sam Curran	11	185	20.55	63	13	26.30	3/28
 Axar Patel	11	149	24.83	66	9	29.77	2/25
 Cameron Green	9	112	18.66	37*	7	31.71	2/12
 Rashid Khan	11	102	20.40	31	8	41.12	2/4

Players with 100+ runs and 5+ wickets in IPL 2024 after 54 matches